MEANING-04 | Therapist only - all age groups

Tension between values and choices

1 | Purpose, fit and boundaries

Purpose of this unit

Explore a situation where two important things pull in different directions and choose a possible step under current conditions. The outcome is not a perfect solution but a limited decision that acknowledges costs and can be updated.

Choice and adaptation

Choose this sheet following professional assessment and with consent. The person may skip questions, answer aloud, or choose another tool. This is proposed original material for review; it provides no score, diagnosis, or promise of an outcome.

Boundaries specific to this unit

Do not use values to justify danger, coercion, or sacrificing a basic need. This sheet does not decide legal, medical, or religious matters. There is no obligation to choose immediately or prove one value superior to another.

Reusing existing material

MEANING-02 clarifies direction and 03 resources. Here, explore tension between directions; existing problem-solving tools can help compare options without replacing reflection on values.

A fictional example for discussion

Fictional example: Shira wants to help a relative and preserve time to rest. She chooses limited assistance and explores further support without deciding that either wish is unworthy.

> Draft for administrator review. Clinical review and final rights approval are still pending.

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Working together with the worksheet

2 | A conversation about one situation

Opening

Choose a situation the person wants to explore. It need not be the hardest situation. Check that the question is understood and the wording fits the person; their account comes before the therapist's interpretation.

1 | Question for discussion

What meaningful directions conflict in the current situation?

2 | Question for discussion

What does each option enable, and what is its cost?

3 | Question for discussion

What commitments, resources, and safety boundaries are relevant?

4 | Question for discussion

What limited choice is reasonable now?

5 | Question for discussion

How will I leave room to update without demanding certainty?

Closing

Summarize what became clearer and what remains open. Use the existing SES-S01 and SES-S02 for the session framework. There is no need to repeat an assessment or plan already recorded.

Possible difficulties

If the dilemma becomes a search for the morally perfect choice, return to conditions and a limited step. A decision with major consequences requires an appropriate setting.

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Adapting for four age groups

3 | Age is a starting point, not an assumption about ability

CH | Children, approximately ages 6 to 11

Choose a small, age-appropriate dilemma. Do not make a child choose between parents, safety, or adults' needs; they may ask for help and not decide.

Offer one question at a time with little writing. Adult support must not replace the child's own voice.

TE | Adolescents, approximately ages 12 to 17

Explore family and social expectations alongside independence. Waiting can be chosen; declaring a hierarchy of values to others is unnecessary.

Agree in advance what will be shared and with whom, and explain the privacy limits in this setting. Do not promise absolute confidentiality.

AD | Adults

Consider commitments and actual capacity. Accepting a particular cost does not mean consenting to harm or replacing suitable advice in the decision's field.

OA | Older adults

Offer time and help according to the participant's wishes. Do not decide for them because of age; a previous preference may change.

Offer reading support, time, and conversation according to preference. Choose help from another person together with the participant, respecting their privacy.

> Each age version needs its own review. Approval of one version does not automatically approve the others.

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Practice, review and next steps

4 | Shared choice and learning from the attempt

Before offering practice sheet P

Choose a limited situation that can be explored in the session. Acting on a major decision between sessions is not required; identifying missing information or assistance is an option.

At the next session

Review learning and fit, not absence of regret. Costs can be acknowledged and choices changed without negating the values that led to them.

Professional and technical records

Each version has a separate review record covering age suitability, originality, rights, and fictional filling. Reviewer and date fields remain blank until assigned. File checks or a code merge are not clinical approval. Clinical information stays only in the authorized setting, outside the code repository.

Background references

The following links were used for background only. Questions and adaptations were written afresh for the expansion plan; no questionnaire, scale, or protocol was copied. Adult sources do not validate the child versions. This material makes no claim about session count or treatment effectiveness.

www.matrix.nhs.scot/self-assessment/?programmeId=2244
www.nhs.uk/mental-health/self-help/guides-tools-and-activities/five-steps-to-mental-wellbeing/

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